



Virus in human sperm

New paper suggests that the human sperm can contain at least 27 different viruses.
<http://digit.in/Sprmvrs>



Hyperloop One raises money

Trying to make hyperloop transports a reality, Hyperloop One has raised \$85 million more in their latest funding. <http://digit.in/Hyprlp1Fnd>

Kingston A400 SSD 240 GB

Entry-level upgrade

Price
₹7,299

Kingston's product portfolio targets the entire gamut, from the entry level devices to those aimed at the enthusiast crowd under their HyperX brand. The Kingston A400 which we are going to be looking at happens to fall in the previous category. It's built for those who're yet to make a transition to SSDs from hard drives and need one without massive investment.

We didn't find any accessories in our already open review unit, so no spacers for making the 7mm SSD fit snugly in 9mm caddies and no caddies either.

As usual, we run a round of synthetic tests prior to conditioning the drives. CrystalDiskMark produced 547 MB/s on sequential read and 522 MB/s on sequential write. 4KQD32 read and write speeds were at 391 MBps and 358 MBps, respectively. Post conditioning, sequential speeds dropped to roughly 343 MBps which is better than some entry level TLC SSDs that we've tested.

Upon checking the latency patterns we can see that the Phison PS3111-S11 doesn't match up to Marvell's entry level controllers which is quite expected. However, since these are entry level SSDs, we doubt that the folks going in for these drives are concerned with latency.

The Kingston A400 breathes a new lease of life into the entry-level SSD segment with the updated controller and even the pricing is set to be competitive. Speaking of the competition, we have the WD Green 240 GB SSD, ADATA SV620 and SanDisk SSD Plus SSDs. All of these drives have a similar setup on the inside except for some which do have a cache to help speed up sustained writes. As of now, the Kingston A400 has an advantage over other cache-less SSDs. Which is why the extra 600 bucks that they're charging seems worth the value.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

SA400S37/240G | FORM FACTOR: 2.5-inch | COST/GB: Rs. 30.41 | DIMENSIONS: 100.5 x 69.9 x 7 mm | CONTROLLER: Phison PS3111-S11 | Toshiba 15nm TLC | WARRANTY: 3 years

CONTACT

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ASUS Zenfone Zoom S

Making a comeback

At ₹26,999, the Asus Zenfone Zoom S positions itself against the likes of Moto Z2 Play, OnePlus 3T and the Samsung Galaxy A7 (2017). Like most phones out there, Asus has also opted for a dual camera setup at the back and has a single camera on the front. Images look crisp when shot in auto mode and capture good details. Colour saturation is not perfect and images taken during the day look somewhat overexposed at times.

As for the build, it is as good as it gets. The choice of material used is metal and the quality is right at par with most metal unibody phones in this segment. The 5.5-inch AMOLED display is actually quite good and is really bright. We recorded max luminance of 675 lux, which is actually quite bright. The display also possesses good viewing angles and has a slightly warm tone by default.

With all the heavy gaming, the phone does tend to get a little hot. Asus has added a 5-magnet speaker with an NXP Smart Amp for better audio output. In our PCMark battery test, the phone scored 7 hours and 28 minutes, which is not great, but just good enough.

Overall, the Asus Zenfone Zoom S is a good phone. It has one of the best cameras we have seen from Asus and would easily be amongst the best in its price category. The 5000mAh battery is the only aspect of the phone, which doesn't live upto our expectations, or even half of our expectations.

— Hardik Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Snapdragon 625 | GPU: Adreno 506 | OS: Android 6.0.1 | CARD SLOT: microSD, up to 256 GB | DISPLAY TYPE: AMOLED Panel | SIZE: 5.2 inches | RESOLUTION: 1080 x 1920 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: Dual 12 MP, f/1.7 & f/2.8, OIS | CAMERA SECONDARY: 13 MP, f/2.0, 1.12 µm pixel size.

CONTACT

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PERFORMANCE.....80
 BUILD.....70
 VALUE FOR MONEY....81



Price
₹26,999



FEATURE.....70
 PERFORMANCE.....68
 VALUE.....62
 DESIGN.....81